

Esteban Gaete Flores

+56 9 8305 4041 | estebanagf@gmail.com | theby.github.io | Santiago, Chile

Senior Unity Game Developer with 11 years of experience crafting gameplay systems and development tools for **console, PC, and mobile**. Contributed to **6 commercial titles**, including **2 led from concept to launch**. Skilled in building responsive gameplay, creating efficient tools and systems, and integrating complex systems that enhance **player experience** and **team productivity**. Experienced collaborating with **international, cross-disciplinary teams** in English-speaking environments (remote and on-site).

Core Skills

- C# Programming
- Gameplay Programming
- Performance Optimization
- Tool & Editor Development
- Profiling & Debugging
- Systems Design
- Multiplatform Deployment (PC / Console / Mobile)
- UI/UX Implementation
- SDK & Backend Integration

Work Experience

Starseed Forest

Jan 2026 - Jul 2026

Senior Gameplay Programmer (Contract) | Unity, Gameplay Programming, Development Tools, Optimization, C#

Project: [The King's Despair](#) (Roguelike action-adventure Top-down, Released TBA)

- Architected the **combat system** from scratch using a symmetric pipeline shared by **player and enemy** characters.
- Implemented **NavMeshPlus for 2D top-down navigation** and built the **enemy AI** on **Unity's Behavior Tree**, with custom cone-of-sight perception and target memory.
- Created an **Aseprite-to-Unity animation pipeline** and tool that made the **animation-driven combat** and weapon systems fast to iterate on.
- **Improved runtime performance** across the combat and event systems by eliminating GC allocations.

Octeto Studios

Dec 2025 - Jul 2026

Senior Unity Engineer | Unity, Android, Optimization, Porting, C#

Project: [Sky Oceans: Wings for Hire](#) (Turn-based exploration JRPG, Released Jul 2026)

- Leading the Android port of Sky Oceans, a JRPG shipped on Nintendo Switch, re-engineering a console-class game to **run within the memory and performance constraints** of mobile hardware.
- Designed a **full touch-input layer** with a virtual joystick, dynamic input-mode detection and translation of the gameplay input map.
- **Adapted 30+ UI screens** for touch interaction and multi-resolution layouts (4:3, 16:9, widescreen).
- **Hardened the IL2CPP/ARM64 build pipeline.**
- Built custom editor tooling to audit and **migrate ~4,000 textures** from Switch-specific formats to Android ASTC compression.

Burlingame Studios

Nov 2021 - May 2025

Senior Gameplay Engineer | Unity, iOS, Android, UI Development, Optimization, SQLite, C#

Project: [Garden Joy](#) (F2P Garden Design & Simulation Game, Released Jan 2022)

- Delivered **25+ live updates**, supporting a **4.8/5 App Store rating** and **1M+ installs**.
- Integrated **Unity** art assets, **REST API** backend data, and **UI systems** to ensure stable performance across mobile devices.

- Collaborated with a **20+ person cross-disciplinary team** (engineering, design, art, product) to support continuous **feature development** and **content updates**.

Starseed Forest

May 2024 - Aug 2024

Senior Unity Engineer (Contract) | Unity, Construct 3, Nintendo Switch, Development Tools, Optimization, C#

Project: [The Eightfold Path](#) (Open-world exploration & puzzle adventure, Released Aug 2024)

- Improved **runtime performance by 50%+** on **Nintendo Switch** and **PC** by performing profiling, memory optimization, and asset-level optimization on the open-world asset streaming loading.
- Developed automated **Unity content-porting tools** that migrated **100% of The Eightfold Path game content** (maps, objects, systems) from **Construct 3 to Unity**, reducing manual setup time by **~80%**.
- Implemented **asset streaming** and **content-loading pipelines** to support seamless **2D open-world generation** and reduce loading interruptions.

Globant

Jan 2021 - Oct 2021

Senior Software Engineer | Unity, iOS, Android, Development Tools, Optimization, C#

Project: [NBA Clash](#) (Deck Builder Sports Game, Released Nov 2022)

- Integrated **custom SDKs** and analytics tools, reducing the **build process from 7 days to 2** and improving delivery reliability.
- Debugged and maintained **multiplayer networking systems**, enhancing **stability, synchronization**, and overall match performance.
- Coordinated **2 international teams** (Chile & USA) to align **workflows, production goals**, and cross-disciplinary collaboration.

IguanaBee

Dec 2020 - Jan 2021

Game Engineer | GameMaker, Development Tools, Optimization, GML

Project: [What Lies in the Multiverse](#) (Puzzle Platformer, Released Mar 2022)

- Ported the entire project from **GameMaker 1 to 2**, modernizing **internal systems** to improve **stability, scalability**, and support for **10 full chapters** across **5 platforms**.
- **Upgraded core engine components** to support **larger levels, modular content expansion**, and improved long-term maintainability.
- **Developed and enhanced internal cinematic and scripting tools**, reducing narrative and event implementation time by **~50%**.

Spoonman Games

Jul 2017 - Nov 2020

Co-founder, Lead Game Engineer | Unity, Nintendo Switch, Gameplay Programming, Development Tools, C#

Project: [Linked Mask](#) (2D Action-Adventure Platformer, Published by HypeTrain Digital, Released Sep 2022)

- **Led end-to-end development** of *Linked Mask*, managing a **6-12 person team** and overseeing **production, scheduling, and delivery** from concept through release.
- **Developed core gameplay systems**, custom **Unity editor tools**, and a **reusable platformer framework** that accelerated prototyping and feature development.
- **Represented the studio** at international conferences (**GDC, MIGS, Digital Dragons**) to **pitch projects**, build publisher relationships, and support business development.

Education

Universidad de Santiago de Chile

Mar 2010 - Mar 2016

- Bachelor's Degree: Informatics Engineering

Languages

- Spanish (Native)
- English (Professional Working Proficiency)